RIFUGIO ALPE SERENA

User Manual

1. Introduction

This manual explains how to navigate the application, check availability, create a reservation, access an account. It also allows employees to manage the tables and seating capacity available for each time slot.

2. Overview

Feature	Who can use it	Needs an account?
Browse the home page and hut information	Everyone	No
Check availability (date, time, party size)	Everyone	No
Register and log in	Everyone	No
Book a table	Hikers	Yes
Receive a booking confirmation by email	Hikers	Yes
Define slot capacity (tables and seats per time slot)	Employees	Yes (employee login)

3. Home Page

The home page introduces Rifugio Alpe Serena and provides access to the main sections of the application.

From the top navigation bar, you can:

- Jump to the sections **The Hut**, **Booking**, **Getting there** and **around the hut**.
- Click **Log in** or **Register** to access your account.
- Click **Book a table** (top right) to go straight to the reservation page.

In the main banner, two buttons guide you to the next step:

- **Check availability** – opens the reservation page so you can see which dates and times are free.
- **Create an account** – opens the registration form.

4. Creating an account

You need an account to make a reservation. To create one:

1. Click **Register** in the top bar or **Create an account** on the home page.
2. Fill in the form:
    - **First name** and **Last name**
    - **Email** – your booking confirmation will be sent to this address
    - **Mobile number**
    - **Password** (at least 8 characters) and **Confirm password**. Use the **Show** button to reveal what you typed.

    - **Notes** *(optional)* – for example, "registered mountain guide".
    - **Emergency contact** *(optional)* – a name and phone number the hut can call in an emergency.
3. Click **Create account**.

Already registered? Use the **Log in** link at the bottom of the form.

5. Logging in

1. Click **Log in** in the top bar.
2. Enter your **Email** and **Password**. Click **Show** next to the password if you want to check what you typed.
3. Click **Log in**.

No account yet? Use the **Register** link under the button. Hut employees also log in on this same page to manage the hut.

6. Checking availability

Anyone can check availability, even without logging in. Open the reservation page (**Check availability** or **Book a table**) and follow the three steps on screen.

Step 1 – Choose a date

- The calendar shows one month at a time. Use the **‹** and **›** arrows to move between months.
- **Available dates are highlighted** and marked with a green dot. Dates without a dot are unavailable and cannot be selected.
- In the example screenshot for November 2026, the available dates are 6, 8, 10 and 13.

Step 2 – Choose a time

After you select an available date, the time slots for that day appear in the **Choose a time** panel. Until a date is selected, the panel shows the message "Select an available date".

7. Booking a table

1. **Log in** (or register). If you are not logged in, the **Your selection** bar shows the message "Please log in or register to make a reservation", with **Log in** and **Register** buttons.
2. Choose a **date**, a **time** and your **party size** as described in section 5.
3. Check your choices in the **Your selection** bar.
4. Click **Confirm reservation**. The button becomes active once a date and time are selected.

About tables and seats: a reservation defines a number of seats that share the same table. If a party is larger than a single table, it can be spread over more than one table.

8. Booking confirmation

After a successful reservation you receive confirmation containing the details of your booking, so you know the reservation was successful. The notification is sent **by email** to the hiker who made the reservation, so make sure the email you registered with is correct.

The confirmation is intended to include relevant booking information, such as:

- Reservation date.
- Reserved time slot.
- Number of guests.
- Other relevant booking details.

The confirmation email is sent after the reservation has been successfully processed.

9. Employee Functionalities

9.1. Defining slot capacity

Hut employees manage the hut from a dedicated set of **Staff tools**. They define the service hours of each day and the tables available in each time slot, and they can follow how many seats are booked. This limits bookings so that the hut does not accept more customers than it can serve, and it controls the availability that hikers see on the booking calendar.

9.1.1 Logging in as an employee

Employees log in on the normal **Log in** page with their staff email and password. Once logged in:

- The top bar shows your name and role, plus a **Log out** button.
- The navigation now includes **Home** and **Slots**.
- The home page banner offers a **Manage slots** button instead of the hiker buttons.

9.1.2 Creating a time slot

Open **Define slot** (or **Manage slots**) to reach the **Create a time slot** page, where you set the service hours and assign the tables available for that slot.

1. **Choose a date.** Pick any calendar date. Use the **‹** and **›** arrows to change month. The selected day is shown in a box below the calendar.
2. **Set the starting time.** Click the time field and choose hour, minutes and AM/PM from the dropdown.
3. **Set the ending time.** Same as above.
4. **Add the tables for this slot.** The **Tables for this slot** panel starts empty ("No tables added yet"). You can either:
    - click **+ Add table** to add tables one by one (see 8.3), or
    - click **Copy tables** to reuse the configuration from another time slot.
5. Check the **Next time slot** summary at the bottom. It shows the date, the time range, and the number of tables and total seats.

6. Click **Create time slot**. A green message confirms the slot was created successfully.

9.1.3 Adding a table

Clicking **Add table** opens the **Add table** window, where you enter the identification table number, the table capacity, that is the number of seats available in that table, and the location of the table inside the hut.

9.1.4 Copying a table

Clicking the Copy Tables opens the Copy table window, where you can pick a date and you will be shown all the time slots already created for that date, where you can copy the table configuration of that timeslot

9.2 Viewing slots and capacity

The **Slots** page (**Slots and capacity**) shows the time slots of the hut and how many seats are booked in each one.

- **Date controls:** use the **−** and **+** arrows to move one day back or forward, pick a date directly, click **Today** to jump to the current day, or **Refresh** to reload the data.
- **Define slot:** opens the Create a time slot page described in 8.2.
- **Day summary:** four figures for the selected day: **Slots**, **Seats booked**, **Seats free** and **Total seats**.
- **Each slot** appears as a card with its time range (for example 12:00 – 13:30), the number of tables and seats, a status badge such as **Available** or **Empty**, and a progress bar. Below it you see **Booked**, **Free** and **Capacity** seat counts.
- **Show tables / Hide tables:** expands the slot to list its tables, each with the seats booked out of its capacity (for example 0 / 4 booked).

10. General System Rules

- Availability: Only dates with available time slots can be selected.
- Capacity control: The number of guests cannot exceed the available seating capacity.
- Multiple tables: A reservation can use more than one table when necessary.
- Authentication: Users must log in or register before completing a reservation.
- Employee management: Employees define the tables available for each time slot.
- Confirmation: A confirmation email is sent after a successful reservation.

11. Typical Reservation Workflow

1. An employee defines a time slot and assigns the available tables.
2. A hiker accesses the application home page.
3. The hiker selects Book a table or Check availability.
4. The hiker selects an available date.
5. The system displays the available time slots.
6. The hiker selects a time slot and specifies the party size.

7. The system checks whether sufficient seating is available.
8. The hiker logs in or registers if not already authenticated.
9. The hiker confirms the reservation.
10. The system registers the booking and sends a confirmation email.

12. Conclusion

The Mountain Hut Table Reservation System provides a way for hikers to check availability and reserve tables, while allowing employees to manage the hut's seating capacity. By combining time-slot management, availability checking, reservation processing, user authentication, and email confirmation, the application helps prevent overbooking and allows hikers to secure a place for their meals.